

looking to compromise someone's systems whether or not there are huge payoffs—these vandals break in simply because they can. Through your open network, and intentional hacker can destroy the network and every PC on the network. Imagine the cost to your organization if a hacker launches a virus directly into your network or re-initializes the hard drives on every PC they could access.

I don't have any important information that anyone would want to access. Many people believe that their electronic information is not at risk or of little value to anyone who sees it. This is dangerous thinking. With simple sniffing software, every packet of data you send or receive over the wireless network can be read and stored to disk. Most users don't realize that when they access their e-mail from a POP3 account over wireless, their e-mail account username and password are readable over the air. Imagine the access to personal and confidential information a hacker can have after capturing your e-mail password and having unrestricted access to your e-mail account for months on end without being detected.

There's no one within 300 feet of my building, and wireless can't reach beyond that point. Many users falsely believe that they are secure because none of their neighbors are within 300 feet of their home or office. In fact, with a \$100 directional antenna hackers can access your network traffic and PC data from as far as a mile away, making it very difficult to pinpoint the hacker at all. Another common hacker trick is to leave an unmonitored PC in their car, hotel room, or other temporary location. The PC can be connected to an antenna pointing at your office or home and collects gigabytes of network traffic for offline analysis after the PC is retrieved. It is nearly impossible to detect a hacker listening to your network.

If I put in a wireless network, no one else will find it. Did you know there is a website that lists almost 2 million unprotected wireless networks? War driving is the practice of finding